BTC 8-Hour Market Report

BTC ~ $82,400

Tuesday 20 Oct 2026, 23:52 Malaysia time (15:52 UTC)

CoinDesk 11:29pm MYT: $82,388, +0.6% 24h; ~flat on the week

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, range-bound (slight downside skew)	**Next 24h:** $80,800 - $83,600	**Key floor:** $80,000 - $81,300 (50-day MA, round number)	**Big event:** $12.2B monthly expiry Fri 30 Oct 4pm; FOMC Thu 29 Oct 2am

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

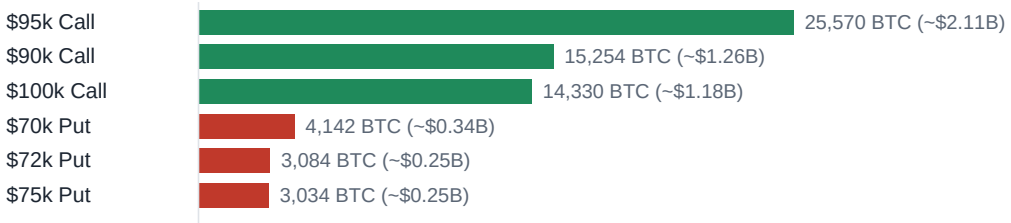
- **Next expiry:** Wed 21 Oct, 4:00pm MYT (08:00 UTC) daily Deribit expiry. Then the weekly on Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm MYT.
- **How big:** small. Daily expiries this week run only a few thousand BTC (Tuesday's was 3,624 BTC, ~$0.3B, largest the $80,000 put at 1,057 BTC). The Fri 23 Oct weekly holds ~14,759 BTC (~$1.2B) - modest.
- **Which expiry matters:** the **Fri 30 Oct monthly** (~$12.2B, ~35% of all Deribit BTC options OI). It dominates positioning into the FOMC and will shape hedging flows all next week.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
Tue 20 Oct 4pm (just settled, reference)	$80,000 Put	1,057 BTC (~$87M)	Traders pay for protection at $80k; same strike reappears across short-dated expiries as the main floor.
Wed 21 Oct 4pm (next 24h)	Strike detail not readable this run	Est. a few thousand BTC (<$0.4B)	Too small to pin price; noise around 4pm MYT only.
Fri 23 Oct 4pm (weekly)	Strike detail not published	~14,759 BTC (~$1.2B)	Moderate; can add some pull toward $80k-$83k into Friday.

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Wed 21 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	Small (<$0.4B est.)	n/a	n/a	Not readable this run
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.2B (14,759 BTC)	n/a	n/a	Not published; prior weekly P/C was 1.37 (put-heavy)
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.2B (149,686 BTC)	0.52	$78,000 - $79,000	Calls $95k (25,570), $90k (15,254), $100k (14,330); Puts $70k (4,142), $72k (3,084), $75k (3,034)
Fri 27 Nov, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$2.2B (26,779 BTC)	n/a	n/a	Not published

Fri 30 Oct monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (BTC, Deribit, as of 17 Oct)



How options affect the market now

- **Next 24h expiry is too small to matter.** Expect at most a brief wobble around 4pm MYT Wednesday; macro (oil, AI stocks, yields) drives price, not options settlement.
- **Max pain pull is down, not up.** The Oct 30 max pain at $78k-$79k sits ~4-5% below spot. As that expiry nears, pin effects can lean on price, but the pull is weak more than a week out.
- **Big call walls are far away.** $90k/$95k/$100k calls (~$4.5B combined) are deep out of the money - they do not cap price now; they only matter if BTC rallies above $86k-$87k, where dealer hedging could accelerate a squeeze.
- **Short-dated sentiment is defensive.** Put/call on the monthly is call-heavy (0.52), but recent short-dated flow is put-heavy (last weekly P/C 1.37) and CoinDesk reports traders buying downside protection today; 25-delta skew is rising.

- **$80k is the options floor.** The $80k put is the most-held short-dated strike. If $80k breaks, put-hedging dealers sell into weakness and the move can extend toward $78k quickly.
- **Volatility is cheap.** DVOL ~37 (down from ~40 on 15 Oct) prices only ~2% (~$1,600) a day. A break of the $80k-$84k range could surprise a market priced for calm.

Data note: the Deribit API could not be reached this run, so strike-level data comes from published reports (CryptoTicker 17 Oct, Admiral Markets, Blockhead). Figures are 'largest seen' and may have shifted; USD sizes use ~$82,400. Daily (21 Oct) and weekly (23 Oct) strike detail, P/C and max pain were not available.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC traded ~$81,100 - $83,100 over the last 24h. It slid to ~$81,400 in the Asian/European session as Asian chip stocks fell (Kospi -3.7%) and Brent hit $111, then bounced to ~$82,400 into the US session.
- The bounce came with short liquidations: $168M of shorts vs $128M of longs liquidated across crypto in 24h (BTC $76M) - a squeeze, not fresh buying.
- Daily closes have held $81,400 - $83,100 since 12 Oct. Sellers capped every push to $84k-$85k; buyers defended ~$80k (15 Oct low ~$79,800).
- Structure: price sits between the 50-day MA (~$81,300-81,500) and the 20-day MA (~$83,200-83,400). A tight, compressed range.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,000 - $84,700	Range ceiling, 7-day high; $84,714 = est. ETF holder cost basis; daily close above $84,246 opens $85.3k / $86.6k
Resistance 1	$83,000 - $83,400	24h high and 20-day MA; Ichimoku Kijun ~$83,460
Pivot	$82,000 - $82,500	Mid-range; flipped between support and resistance all week
Support 1	$81,300 - $81,500	50-day MA, Ichimoku cloud edge, est. ETF average cost
Support 2	$79,800 - $80,000	Round number, 15 Oct low, largest short-dated put strike
Deep risk	$78,000 - $79,000	Oct 30 max pain; 20x long liquidation zone (~$78.5k)
Tail	$75,000 / $72,000	Sept low $74,968 and 200-day MA ~$72,600; put strikes $75k/$72k

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
DVOL (30d implied vol)	~37.4 (20 Oct am)	Low; implies ~2.0% (~$1,600) daily move
Futures open interest	646,442 BTC (15 Oct, 22 exch.)	Up 4.3% since 12 Oct while price fell - leverage rebuilding
Deribit options OI	391,164 BTC (20 Oct)	~38% of it in the Oct 30 expiry
Funding rates	Positive, modest	Turned positive on recovery toward $83k; no extreme long crowding reported
Liquidations (24h)	$297M crypto; BTC $76M	Shorts $168M > longs $128M - bounce driven by short squeeze
Spot BTC ETF flows	+$527M Mon 19 Oct	Biggest day in a month, all IBIT (+$665M); Fidelity/Grayscale outflows. Prior week -$228M
ETH ETF flows	-$103M Mon 19 Oct	Fourth straight outflow day
Fear & Greed	49 (Neutral)	Down from 59 on 19 Oct and 69 last week
Options skew	25-delta skew rising	More demand for downside protection

4. News and macro

- **Oil shock:** attacks in Saudi Arabia and on Strait of Hormuz shipping pushed Brent above $111 (five-month high); energy-led inflation risk keeps rate-hike fears alive.
- **AI / tech sell-off:** Kospi fell ~4% on a weak data-centre IPO; CoreWeave and miners lower pre-market. BTC trades ~85% correlated with the S&P 500, so tech earnings (Netflix Tue; Meta, Tesla Wed) matter.
- **Fed:** in blackout before the 27-28 Oct FOMC. Policy rate 3.75%-4.00% after a September hike; Sept CPI 3.7% y/y (hot). Market sees ~15% odds of a hike on 28 Oct but high odds of a December hike. 10-year yield ~5.1%.
- **ETF demand:** IBIT's +$665M (largest in over a year) lifted Monday flows to +$527M, but rivals saw outflows. BlackRock also filed a downside-protected bitcoin ETF (PBIT).
- **Structure / regulation:** MSCI's 'non-operating' screen (final list 11 Nov, effective 30 Nov) could drop Strategy (JPM: up to $2.8B outflows). CFTC rebuffs CME in the perpetual-futures dispute; France votes to tax stablecoin trades.
- **Long view:** JPMorgan projects ~10% annual BTC returns over the next decade.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Wed 21 Oct, 2:00pm	UK September CPI
Wed 21 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily BTC options expiry (small)
Wed 21 Oct, 10:30pm	US EIA crude oil inventories (oil is the key macro driver)
Thu 22 Oct, ~4:00-5:00am	Meta, Tesla, Lam Research earnings (after US close)
Thu 22 Oct, 8:30pm	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly expiry (~$1.2B)
Fri 23 Oct, 9:45pm	US flash PMIs (S&P Global)
Sun 25 Oct	Brazil presidential runoff
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am / 2:30am	**FOMC decision / Powell press conference** (hold expected)
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30pm	US September PCE inflation
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	**Deribit monthly expiry ~$12.2B**, max pain $78k-$79k
Tue 10 Nov, 9:30pm	US October CPI
Wed 11 Nov	MSCI final list on digital-asset-heavy companies

5. Summary and prediction

Bitcoin is stuck in a tight $80k-$84k range, squeezed between bearish macro (oil above $110, 5% yields, an AI-stock wobble, a hawkish Fed) and supportive flows (IBIT's biggest inflow in over a year, buyers at $80k). Options add little in the next 24 hours: the Wednesday and Friday expiries are small, while the $12.2B Oct 30 monthly - with max pain at $78k-$79k and calls stacked far away at $90k-$100k - is the real event and lands just after the FOMC. Short-dated traders are buying puts and implied vol is low, so a break of the range could move fast; the downside break is slightly more likely than the upside one given oil and equities. **24h call: range $80,800 - $83,600 with a slight downside lean; watch $81,300 and $83,400.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range	55%	$80,800 - $83,600	Oil steady near $105-111, mixed tech earnings, ETF flows flat to positive
Bullish	20%	$83,400 - $84,700	Oil retreats, Nasdaq rebounds, another IBIT inflow day; hourly close above $83,400 squeezes shorts
Bearish	25%	$79,000 - $80,800	Brent higher, Kospi/Nasdaq slide, ETF outflows; loss of $81,300 then $80k puts fuel selling toward $79k

- **Bull signal:** 4h close above $83,400 with rising spot volume, then a daily close above $84,250.
- **Bear signal:** 4h close below $81,300; a daily close below $80,000 opens $78k-$79k (Oct 30 max pain).

- Next report: Wed 21 Oct, 7:50am MYT

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